

1.2 The Evolution of the Handset

The first mobile phone

The first mobile phones were installed only in cars. The transmitting and receiving equipment was installed in the boot of the car, and a handset was placed next to the driver. It was only with the coming of 1G mobile networks that a headset could be carried around without the assistance of heavy machinery.

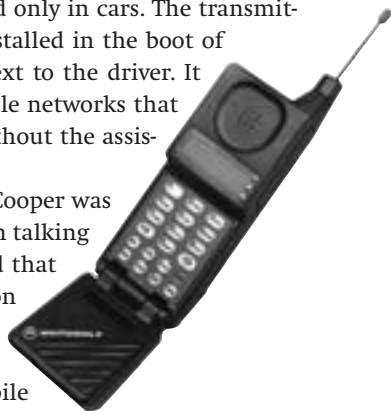
In 1972, Motorola's Dr Martin Cooper was spotted on the streets of Manhattan talking into a brick. It was soon discovered that the good doctor's mental condition was quite normal, and that the brick was in fact the Motorola

DynaTAC—the first true mobile

phone. It was about the size of a VHS videotape, with a rubber antenna at the top.



Our favourite brick, the Motorola DynaTAC



The Motorola MicroTAC

The next instrument of consequence was the Motorola MicroTAC (1989), the smallest and lightest phone available for analogue networks. It weighed in at 7.8 ounces and could store a relatively gargantuan 20 phone numbers.

2G handsets

The coming of 2G networks was when handset designs really started to take off. Because connecting to a 2G network required lesser power, the transmitting units could be made smaller and phones were thus easier to carry around.

In 1993, Nokia released the 1011—the first digital hand phone



The Nokia 1011—the first true 2G handset

